visitor expectations. This involves leveraging online platforms for advertising, bookings, and information dissemination, enhancing tourists' overall experience from the comfort of their homes.

ENCOURAGING PRIVATE SECTOR INVESTMENT

The policy facilitates private sector investment in hospitality and tourism projects, seeking to reduce government involvement in areas where private participation can be more effective. Streamlined approval processes will promote ease of doing business, stimulating innovation and growth.

To achieve balanced regional development, the policy introduces the "Hub and Spoke" model, addressing carrying capacity issues in popular destinations. Improvements in basic amenities and infrastructure are designed to enhance the visitor experience and ensure resilience to natural disasters. The ambitious goals of the Uttarakhand Tourism Policy 2023-30 include contributing USD 10 billion annually to the state's economy and attracting substantial private investments. By generating job opportunities and focusing on skill development and inclusivity, the policy aims to increase the average length of stay and boost foreign tourist visits.

EMBRACING UTTARAKHAND'S NATURAL AND CULTURAL WEALTH

Uttarakhand, also known as Devbhoomi or "Land of the Gods," is renowned for its majestic Himalayan landscapes, sacred pilgrimage sites, and rich cultural heritage. The state offers a remarkable blend of untouched beauty, adventure, spirituality, and traditional hospitality, making it an ideal destination for visitors seeking diverse experiences.

THE MANASKHAND EXPRESS: A SPIRITUAL JOURNEY

In an innovative step by the CM Dhami-led government to highlight Uttarakhand's cultural and spiritual significance, the Indian Railways has introduced the Manaskhand Express-Bharat Gaurav Tourist Train. This train, operated by the Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation (IRCTC) in collaboration with the Uttarakhand Tourism Development Board, offers a curated journey through the Kumaon region, also known as Manaskhand in ancient Indian scriptures.

The inaugural voyage of the Manaskhand Express began from Pune on April 22, 2024, carrying 280 enthusiastic tourists. The train, adorned with depictions of Uttarakhand's rich heritage, travels to destinations including Nainital, Bhimtal, Almora, Chaukori, Puragiri Temple, and more. The travel package includes comfortable train journeys, hotel stays, homestays, guided tours, meals, and travel insurance. Upon arriving at Tanakpur Railway Station, tourists are welcomed in traditional Indian style with aarti, tikka, and flower petals. The journey includes visits to various temples, scenic spots, and cultural sites, providing a comprehensive experience of Uttarakhand's lesser-known treasures. The train's pantry car serves a variety of dishes, including Uttarakhandi cuisine, enriching the cultural immersion for tourists.



"I congratulate the Uttarakhand government on the remarkable progress achieved in the last few years. This has been made possible by sustained policy push and focus on key sectors such as tourism and renewable energy. Alongside, the state has made significant strides in infrastructure development, setting new benchmark for sustainable growth. Uttarakhand's commitment to harnessing its natural resources and promoting tourism has not only bolstered its economy but also showcased its potential on the global stage. I applaud the state's dedication to inclusive development and look forward to its continued success in the years ahead.

– **Shri Narendra Modi**, Prime Minister, Government of India

TEHRI: TRANSFORMING INTO A PRIME WEDDING DESTINATION AND ADVENTURE HUB

The scenic Tehri district in Uttarakhand is undergoing a transformative journey to emerge as a premier destination for weddings and adventure sports. With strategic development initiatives and the enthusiastic support of stakeholders, Tehri is poised to attract couples seeking a unique and memorable location for their special day.

A notable highlight is the evolution of Tehri as a tent city. This enterprise, functioning on a Public-Private-Partnership (PPP) model, strives to provide an immaculate and close–Knit wedding experience. The tranquil setting of Tehri Lake, complemented by lavish tent and contemporary conveniences, pledges to create special memories for wedding receptions. The Uttarakhand government's emphasis on fostering Tehri as a wedding destination aligns with PM Narendra Modi's special appeal to promote domestic tourism by means of destination weddings. This endeavour ia a component of wider campaign to maintain the financial advantage of such occasions within India, thus supporting local residents and enterprises.

A chopper services to Triyuginarayan temple will soon be introduced to improve Tehri's charm and appeal. This service will cater to visitors, especially couples desiring to get married at this holy temple, traditionally considered the venue of Lord Shiva and Parvati's marriage. After the marriage rituals, the wedding celebrations can continue in the picturesque surroundings of Tehri, offering a seamless combination of spirituality and festivity.

